

The Backyard Treasure Hunt

Little adventurers • 3-4 years old



Once upon a time, in a sunny little town, there were two best friends named Jack and Tom. Jack loved to explore, and Tom was always curious. Jack used a shiny blue wheelchair that zoomed like a race car. Together, they loved to turn every day into a grand adventure.

One bright morning, Jack and Tom decided to explore the backyard. « **Let's find treasure!** » said Tom, his eyes sparkling with excitement. « **Yes, a treasure map!** » Jack agreed, nodding happily.

They found an old piece of paper in their playhouse. « **This will be our map,** » Jack said, holding it up. They drew a big red X on it. « **The treasure is under the big oak tree!** » Tom exclaimed.

Off they went, Jack rolling fast and Tom skipping beside him. They reached the big oak tree, its leaves whispering secrets in the wind. « **Look, there's a shiny stone!** » Tom pointed, picking it up.

Jack looked closely. « **It's a magic stone,** » he said with a grin. Tom nodded. « **Now, we need to cross the river,** » Tom said, pointing to the garden hose on the grass.

Jack and Tom imagined the garden hose was a big, flowing river. « **Careful,** » Jack warned, « **We need a bridge!** » They found a long wooden plank and placed it over the hose.

« **Here we go,** » said Tom, holding Jack's hand. They crossed the plank one at a time, giggling. « **We did it!** » Jack cheered.

Next, they pretended the flower bed was a jungle. « **Watch out for lions!** » Jack warned, waving his arms like a lion's paws. Tom roared loudly, making them both laugh.

When they finally reached the sandbox, Tom dug carefully with his little shovel. « **I found something!** » he shouted. Jack leaned over to see. It was a small wooden box.

Inside the box, they found a note that read, « **You found the treasure! Keep exploring!** » Jack and Tom looked at each other and smiled.

« **Exploring is fun,** » Jack said. « **Yes, and it's even better with friends,** » Tom replied. They closed the box, happy with their adventure.

As the sun began to set, they knew more adventures awaited them tomorrow. Together, they were unstoppable explorers, ready to turn every day into a new journey.

The quiz: did you understand the story well?

1) Who are the two best friends in the story?

- Jack and Tom
- Alice and Ben
- Sara and Max
- Lily and Joe

2) Where did they think the treasure was?

- Under the big oak tree
- In the bathtub
- On the roof
- In the car

3) What did they pretend the garden hose was?

- A big river
- A long road
- A magic snake
- A tall ladder

4) What did Tom find in the sandbox?

- A small wooden box
- A golden crown
- A big fish
- A red balloon

Correct answers:

1) Jack and Tom 2) Under the big oak tree 3) A big river 4) A small wooden box

Glossary: complicated words in the story

Explore: To go and look around places to find new things and learn.

Curious: Wanting to know about things and asking many questions.

Wheelchair: A chair with wheels that helps someone move around.

Adventure: A fun or exciting trip where you try new things.

Playhouse: A small house to play in, like a pretend home.

Whispering: Speaking very quietly so only nearby people can hear.

Oak tree: A big tree with strong wood and many leaves.

Garden hose: A long tube that carries water to plants or the yard.

Plank: A long, flat piece of wood you can walk on.

Treasure: Special things that are shiny or valuable and make people happy.